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WORLD OF FOOTBALL

The Vini show rolls on

Vinicius delivered the **decisive blow** against Benfica as Real Madrid moved into the Champions League last 16.

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While Real Madrid winger Vinicius Jr's (**above, left**) dance near the corner flag was strongly detested by Benfica fans in their UCL playoff first-leg match, the same gesture was widely celebrated by spectators in white when he found the back of the net in the reverse fixture.

The tie was under heavy spotlight after Gianluca Prestianni allegedly directed a racist remark at Vinicius after he scored the only goal in the first leg. The Argentine was provisionally suspended by UEFA, while manager Jose Mourinho was also missing from the touchline after earning a red card in the chaos that ensued.

However, despite being short-staffed, it was Benfica

that struck first, to level the tie, courtesy of an early Rafa Silva strike. But the parity lasted just two minutes as Aurelien Tchouameni found the bottom corner from the edge of the box before Vinicius sealed the game with 10 minutes of regulation time left, breaking out his moves this time in front of the grateful home support.

Meanwhile, Juventus and Galatasaray delivered a European classic, with the former almost pulling off a memorable comeback. Heading to Turin with a three-goal advantage, Galatasaray was put on the back foot with Manuel Locatelli converting from the spot ahead of the break. Lloyd Kelly's red card early in the second half seemed to have dashed Juve's chances, but Federico Gatti and Weston McKennie scored in the last 20 minutes to send